

When the Going Gets Tough: A Community Restoration Toolkit

Facilitated by Tayllor Oyewole-Davis

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Tayllor Oyewole-Davis

A little about me & **Sisterhood(verb)** — a community rooted in grace, integrity, and mutual care.

Who I Am

Tayllor Oyewole-Davis is a Mount Holyoke alumna, poet, and the founder of Sisterhood(verb), a community platform and app built to help women find real, grounded connection with each other. She holds a master's degree from NYU and has spent her career at the intersection of community building, arts education, and conflict restoration — work she now brings back to MHC students through Sisterhood(verb)'s workshops and programming.

Why I'm Here

I'm here because conflict in community isn't a sign something's broken — it's a sign people are actually in relationship with each other. What determines whether that conflict turns into drama or turns into growth is whether we have the tools to move through it. That's what we're building together today.

Community Agreements

Respect

Honor each person's experience

Confidentiality

What's shared here stays here

Assume Best Intentions

With care and honesty

Growth Mindset

We're here to learn, not judge

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Our Intention Today

Explore what restoration looks like when community members are in conflict — and how we can rebuild with grace, integrity, and respect for ourselves and each other.



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Community Check-In: Where Did the Day Leave You?



PolleEv: Drop your answer in the chat or poll.



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Today's Agenda

01

Community Consciousness

How our experience shapes how we engage

02

Conflict

Where it starts and how it moves

03

How it Spreads

The cycle of discomfort

04

Restoration Toolkit

Practical tools to break the cycle

05

What Makes It Work

Curiosity, practice, and purpose

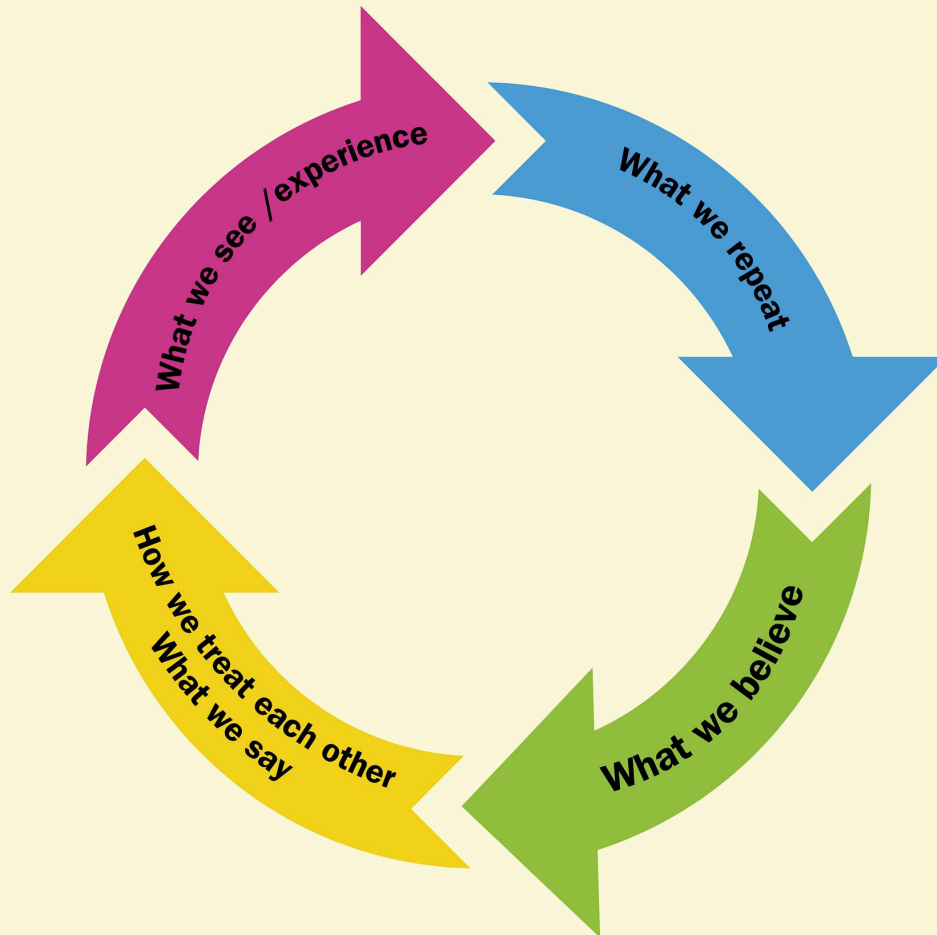
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COMMUNITY CONSCIOUSNESS

What You Experience(d) Shapes How You Show Up

Where you come from and what norms you have coming into the community inform the norms within that community

- The more we know about ourselves, our patterns, and our process, the more we can show up fully in community with others



Community Consciousness:

What we see, experience, repeat, and believe about ourselves and each other inform what we say and how we treat others.

Conflict Starts in the Body



 **PollEv:** When you feel conflicted or upset — where in your body do you feel it first?

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When We Are Hurt, We Make A Choice...

What It Looks Like:

When the discomfort of conflict is activated in our bodies, we...

1

Keep It To Ourselves

2

Give It To Someone Else

3

We Landmine!



1. **Keep It To Ourselves**
 - a. Anxious
 - b. Obsessive
 - c. Internalizing Discomfort
 - d. Silence
2. **Give it To Someone Else**
 - a. Aggressive aggressive
 - b. Passive aggressive
 - c. Gossip
3. **Landmine**
 - a. Aggressive Outburst
 - b. Physical altercation
 - c. Gossip 2.0

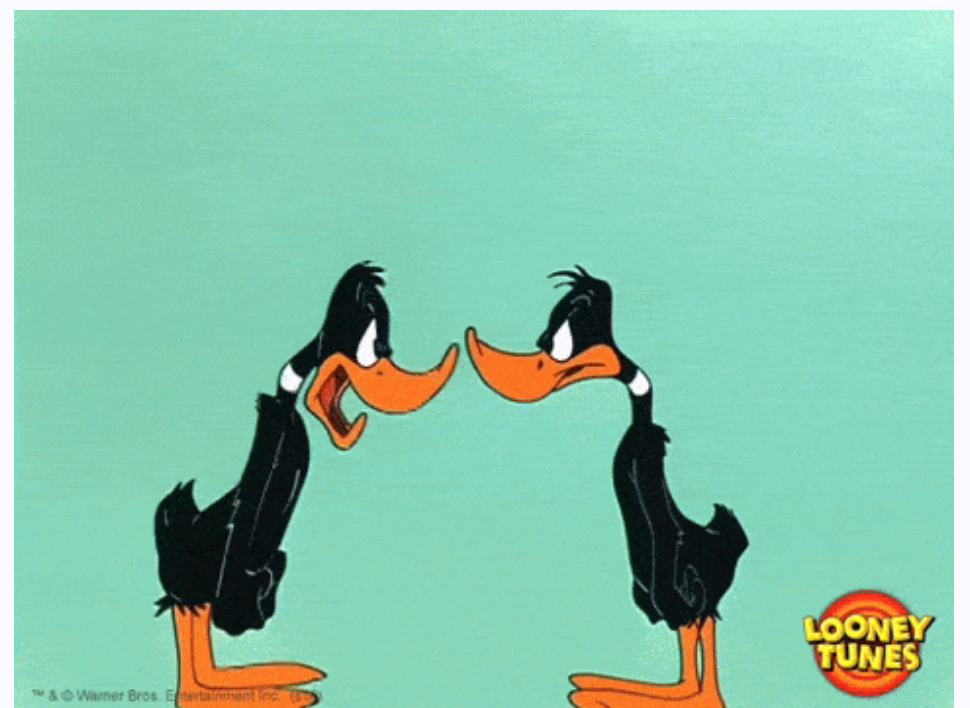


What This Looks Like In Community



GOSSIP

Tension



Distracted from
our primary
purpose



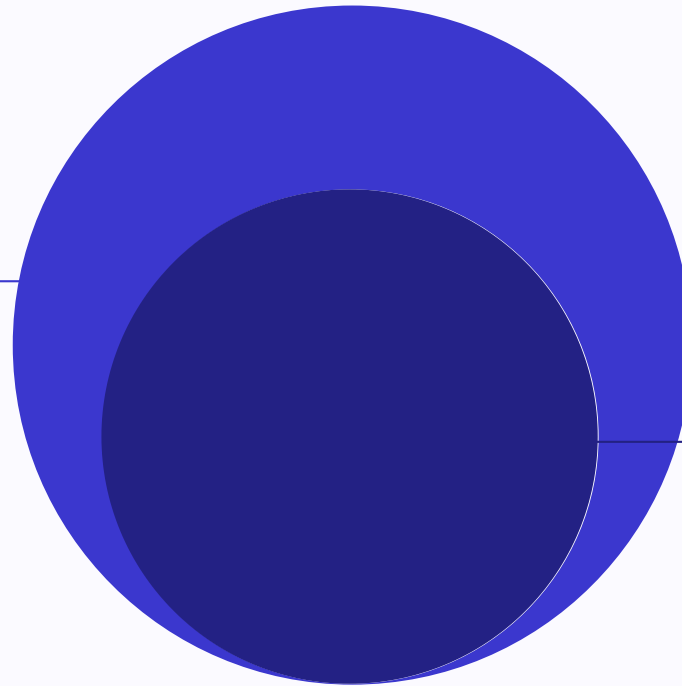
We can't avoid ALL conflict, but we can create a path forward when things go awry...

The Restoration Toolkit

A process to move from reactivity to restoration — for yourself and your community.

Restore & Reform

Restore relationships
and/or reform community
norms to better serve the
community.



Self-Regulate & Reflect

Regulate body and mind,
leaving room for processing
emotions, facts, and the way
forward

Self-Regulate & Reflect

P.A.U.S.E

Pause

Action

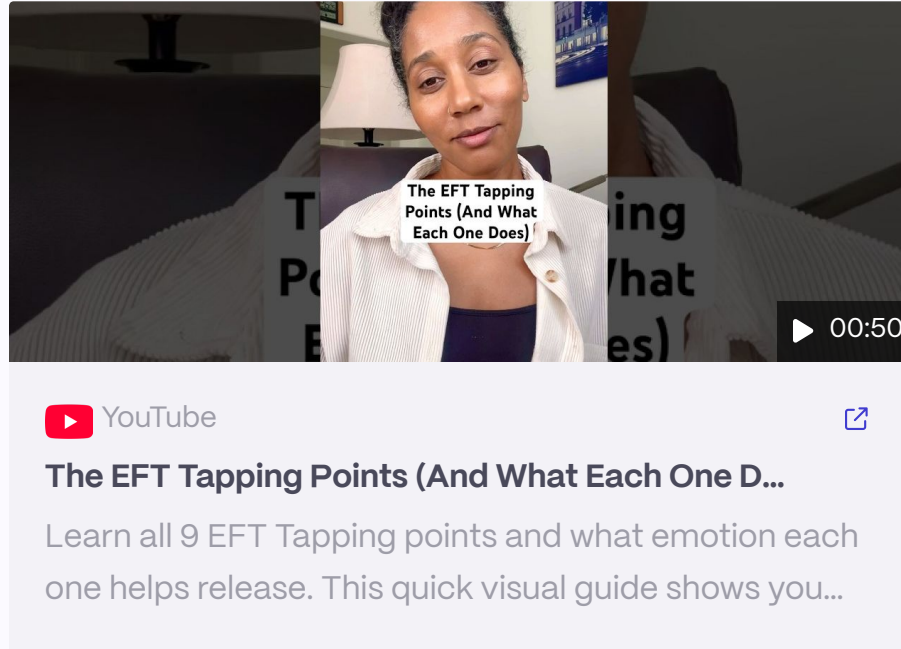
Until

Sensations

Exit

Extra Credit: Name it!

REGULATE THE BODY



Emotional Freedom Tapping (EFT) - A self-help acupressure method that involves tapping on specific meridian points of the bod

REFLECT

- Journal
- Vent with a neutral friend (mom, partner, parent, trusted friend)
- Meditation
- Take SPACE



What Does Moving Forward Look Like?

It could look like:

1. **Mediation** - Trusted friend to help clear the space to hear each other out to help highlight the harm, the restoration, and different behavior moving forward
2. **Courageous Conversation** - The goal: Understanding & Acknowledgment
3. **Restoration:** It doesn't have to look like rainbows and kittens and skittles. It can look like understanding with respect.
4. **Reformation:** Has this conflict highlighted a norm in our community that is causing harm? How do we address this together?

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What Makes It Work?



Know Yourself

Self-awareness = better regulation



Know Your Community

Understanding makes support easier



Practice Makes Progress

Conflict is inevitable — drama is not



Primary Purpose First

We are not here to be right, we are here to be *together*



Thoughts? Questions? Access the Sisterhood(verb) app to continue the journey.

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In Closing...

What is one thing that you learned or are curious about when it comes to conflict resolution, your relationship to conflict, and your community?



Thank you for your time & care!

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Join the Sisterhood(verb) app!
Make sure to use your @mtholyoke.edu email address for premium access.



A private community for *women who are ready to practice community building not just talk about it.

Sister Circles | Community Feed | Resources | Library | Events

No followers to gain. No algorithm to feed. Just women showing up for each other.

**This space is open to self-identified women, as well as gender nonconforming individuals, you are welcome to call this place home.*

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